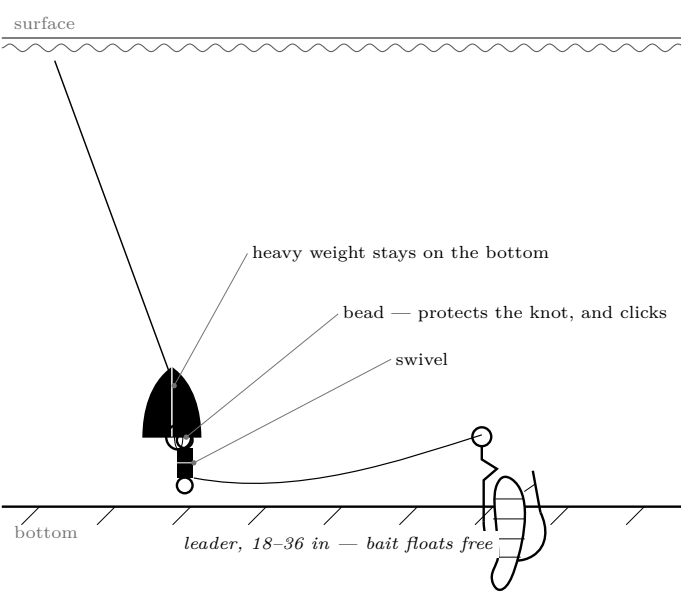




What it does A heavy weight stays on the bottom and telegraphs exactly what the bottom is made of, while the bait trails behind on a long leader, floating free.

Versus Texas A Texas rig puts the weight *at* the bait; a Carolina rig separates them. Texas gets into cover; Carolina covers ground and keeps the bait visible.

Components 3/8–3/4 oz weight, glass or brass bead, barrel swivel, 18–36 in leader, offset hook, soft plastic.

The bead Sits between weight and swivel. It protects the knot and it clicks — an audible attractor on a hard bottom.

Leader length Short (18 in) in cold water or heavy weed; long (36 in) in clear water and on a clean bottom.

Line 15 lb main, 10–12 lb leader, so a snag breaks off the bait and not the whole rig.

Build it

1. Thread the **weight** onto the main line, then the **bead**.
2. Tie the main line to a **barrel swivel**.
3. Tie the **leader** to the other end of the swivel, then the **hook** to the leader.
4. Rig the plastic weedless exactly as for a *see the **Texas rig** sheet*, or on an open hook if the bottom is clean.

Fish it

Cast long	This is a long-cast rig. The weight carries it, and the long leader means it needs a slow, wide casting stroke or it will tangle.
Drag, do not hop	Sweep the rod sideways, low and slow, to drag the weight across the bottom. Reel up the slack, reposition, sweep again.
Feel the bottom	You are mapping structure by touch. Sand feels smooth, gravel grinds, rock knocks, weeds load and release. Slow down when the bottom changes — that is where fish are.
The bite	Usually a distinct tick or a mushy weight. Reel down until tight, then sweep. Do not snap.
Where	Pine spot 5 on the outside weed edge, and the flats around the base of the bar at 4 . North spots 3 and 4 .

When to use it

When you need to find fish on a big, featureless-looking flat. The Carolina rig is a search tool that happens to catch fish: it tells you where the bottom changes, and bass live where the bottom changes.

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